Advocacy Tips and Tricks

Business Academy Group Learning · Advocacy · September 2027

Advocacy simply means speaking up for your program, your families, and your field. Your story and your numbers are your strongest tools.

Tell your story

- **Keep it short.** One page or a two-minute conversation.
- **Lead with who you serve.** Families, children, and your community.
- **Use your numbers.** Cost per child, what families pay, and what teachers earn.
- **Share one real story.** With permission, and without private details.
- **End with one clear ask.** What do you want the person to know or do?

Know your decision-makers

- **Local officials.** Board of supervisors, city council, and school board members.
- **State officials.** Your delegate and state senator.
- **Find them easily.** Look up officials by your address on official government websites.
- **Know the calendar.** Many state budget decisions happen during the legislative session early in the year.

Take action

- **Send an email.** Short, personal, and specific.
- **Invite a visit.** Seeing a program in action is powerful.
- **Speak at a meeting.** Public comment time is open to community members.
- **Follow up.** A thank-you note keeps the relationship going.

Speak up together

- **Join a coalition.** Statewide early childhood groups share updates and action alerts.
- **Stay connected to your Ready Region.** Foundation First can share opportunities to speak up.
- **Engage families.** Parents’ voices are powerful too.

Keep it respectful and safe

- **Stay positive and factual.** Focus on solutions.
- **Protect privacy.** Never share family names or details without permission.
- **Keep advocacy separate from public funding rules.** Ask your Business Specialist if you’re unsure what’s allowed when using grant funds or time.

Questions? Contact your Business Specialist: [name, email, phone]